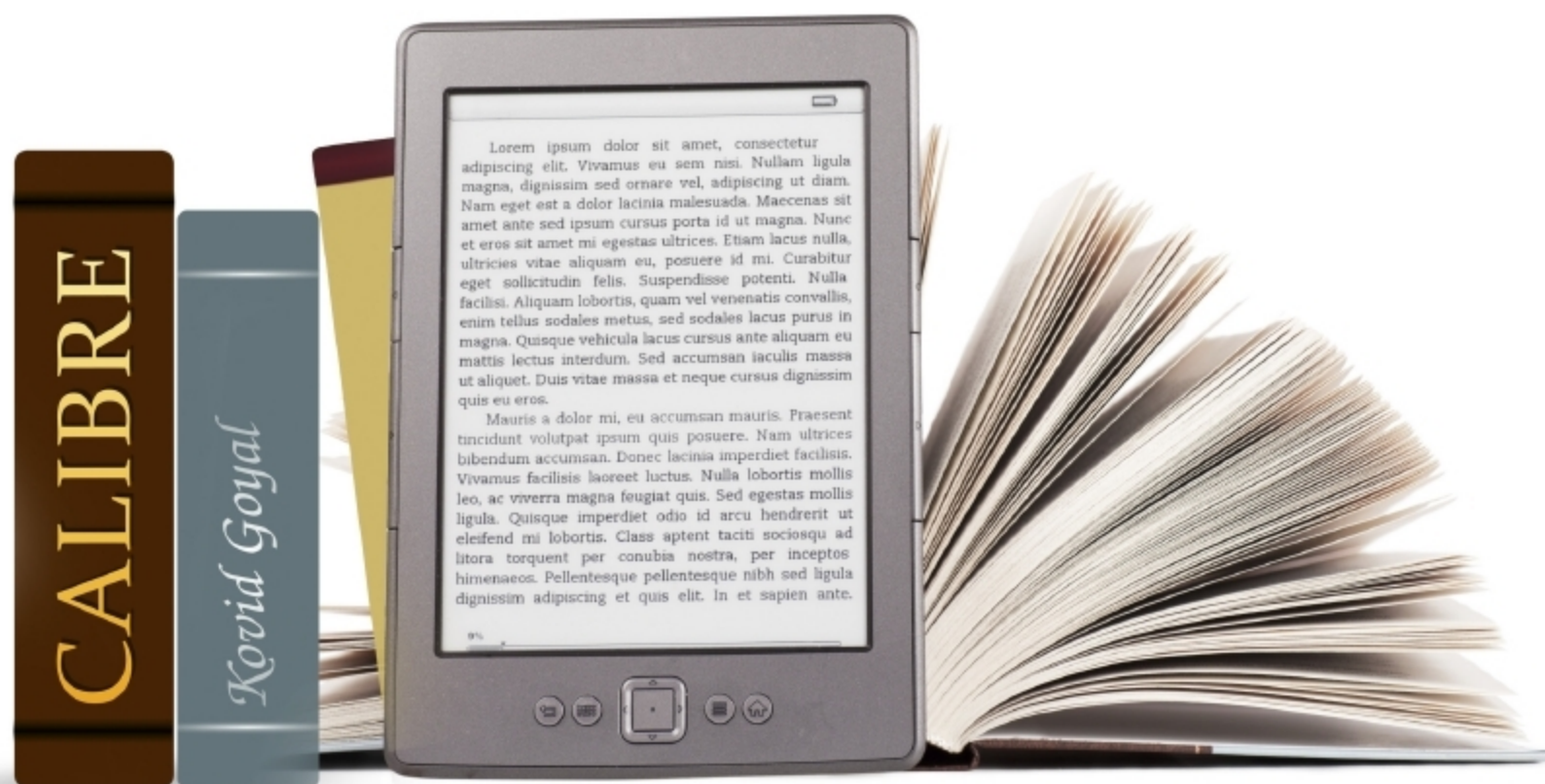


Calibre, the World's Best Open Source e-Book Reader, is Made by an Indian

If you search for 'calibre' online, you will get information related to the e-book management software. The word 'calibre' means many things in the English language – it means one thing to musicians, and quite another to a gun owner. It is also the name of a movie. So, it's interesting that the calibre software shows up before the rest.



Wikipedia also ranks calibre (the software) on top of its lists. Its entry makes it clear that this is a potent software that is well recognised by users worldwide.

Writing in another context, Erez Zukerman said on *makeuseof.com*: “Much has been written about this fantastic free application [calibre e-book manager], and we have an entire manual dedicated to it, titled, ‘Open Book: Managing Your eBooks With Calibre’.” (Check out the links under *References*.) The first release of this

software was over 13 years ago.

It might seem a bit strange that Indians are barely aware that this excellent software, which so many around the world use, has been created by a *desi*.

So the first question I, almost accusingly, asked Kovid Goyal was, “I am hugely impressed by what calibre has accomplished. How come so few recognise that this product has been made by an Indian (or at least, led by one)?”

Kovid shot back: “I don’t know. I don’t advertise the fact that I am Indian, I guess.”

Calibre (spelt as calibre, without a capital letter) has, or is, being translated into about 106 languages worldwide. Spanish and Ukrainian translations are both 100 per cent complete. Other languages include French (99.9 per cent), Swedish (96.4 per cent), German (86.3 per cent), Zulu and Xhosa (barely 0.3 per cent complete, but at least it’s being done), besides many more.

Attempts are being made, with varying degrees of success, to translate it into Telugu, Sinhala, Pushto, Malayalam, Bengali, Hindi (only 3.2 per cent complete), Gujarati, Kannada (34.1 per